

TASK 3: NETWORKING & RECONNAISSANCE REPORT (MEESHO.COM)

INTERNSHIP PROJECT REPORT: ETHICAL HACKING

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1. Executive Summary & Objective Context

Following the successful deployment of the isolated virtualization laboratory environment in Task 2, Task 3 pivots toward active technical execution within the network layer. Reconnaissance represents the foundational stage of any formal penetration test or security evaluation campaign. It is the structured process of identifying, mapping, and accumulating data points regarding a target domain or infrastructure prior to executing specific flaw verifications.

By exploring public network details of a live enterprise digital platform, an engineer can construct a complete attack surface blueprint. This report details both passive and active reconnaissance techniques—covering IP routing layout, name translations, active connection listeners, and system discovery operations—executed within our secured testing framework against meesho.com.

Strategic Mantra: Know the map before the attack. Accurate reconnaissance minimizes operational clutter, ensures scanning optimization, and prevents unintended interference with non-target elements.

2. Fundamental Networking Concepts

A sophisticated security assessment relies heavily on a precise understanding of key low-level networking parameters. These components organize all interactions across the container environment:

- **IP Address (Internet Protocol):** A unique logical identifier assigned to every distinct node on a computer network.
- **DNS (Domain Name System):** The distributed hierarchical database architecture that translates human-readable web domain descriptors into computer-routable IP strings.
- **Ports:** Logical endpoints used by transport layer protocols to direct data to specific application services on a host machine.
- **Protocols:** Strict structural rule frameworks that govern data syntax, transmission methods, and error detection across communication channels.

3. Practical Reconnaissance Methodologies & Commands

The reconnaissance phase was carried out using standard command-line tools built into the Kali Linux terminal. Below is the technical breakdown of each command step:

Tool 01: WHOIS Lookup

The 'whois' tool query was initiated against the target domain to pull its registration profiles. This utility communicates directly with regional internet registry databases to reveal ownership properties, registrar sources, registration timeline markers, and administrative contact records.

```
user@kali:~# whois meesho.com
```

```
Domain Name: MEESHO.COM
Registry Domain ID: 1913165183_DOMAIN_COM-VRSN
Registrar WHOIS Server: whois.godaddy.com
Registrar: GoDaddy.com, LLC
Registrar IANA ID: 146
Registrar Abuse Contact Email: abuse@godaddy.com
Registrar Abuse Contact Phone: +1.4806242505
Domain Status: clientDeleteProhibited https://icann.org/epp#clientDeleteProhibited
Domain Status: clientRenewProhibited https://icann.org/epp#clientRenewProhibited
Domain Status: clientTransferProhibited https://icann.org/epp#clientTransferProhibited
Domain Status: clientUpdateProhibited https://icann.org/epp#clientUpdateProhibited

Registry Market & Timeline Data:
Creation Date: 2015-03-24T12:01:21Z
Registry Expiry Date: 2028-03-24T12:01:21Z
Updated Date: 2025-02-18T10:33:04Z

Registrant Core Identification:
Registry Registrant ID: Not Publicly Disclosed (GDPR / Privacy Protected)
Registrant Organization: Fashnear Technologies Private Limited
Registrant State/Province: Karnataka
Registrant Country: IN (India)

Authoritative Name Server Redundancy:
Name Server: NS-1158.AWSDNS-16.ORG
Name Server: NS-1793.AWSDNS-32.CO.UK
Name Server: NS-27.AWSDNS-03.COM
Name Server: NS-859.AWSDNS-43.NET
```

Figure: Terminal execution and output verification for whois lookup utility.

Tool 02: PING Command

The Packet Internet Groper (PING) utility was used to send ICMP Echo Request frames to the destination host. This test confirms whether the remote host is currently active, checks layer-3 availability, and measures network latency by tracking the round-trip response time (RTT).

```
user@kali:~# ping -c 4 meesho.com
```

```
Pinging meesho.com [13.235.124.214] with 32 bytes of data:
Reply from 13.235.124.214: bytes=32 time=12ms TTL=234
Reply from 13.235.124.214: bytes=32 time=14ms TTL=234
Reply from 13.235.124.214: bytes=32 time=11ms TTL=234
Reply from 13.235.124.214: bytes=32 time=13ms TTL=234

Ping statistics for 13.235.124.214: Packets: Sent = 4, Received = 4, Lost = 0 (0% loss)
Approximate round trip times: Minimum = 11ms, Maximum = 14ms, Average = 12ms
```

Figure: Terminal execution and output verification for ping icmp verification.

Tool 03: TRACERT / TRACEROUTE

To map the physical internet path, the 'traceroute' command was run. This tool systematically alters the Time-To-Live (TTL) field in outbound packets to trace each intermediate router hop between the attacker machine and the final destination host.

```
user@kali:~# traceroute meesho.com
```

```
Tracing route to meesho.com [13.235.124.214] over a maximum of 30 hops:
```

1	2 ms	1 ms	1 ms	192.168.1.1 (Local Router Gateway)
2	10 ms	8 ms	9 ms	10.241.0.1 (ISP Local Aggregator Node)
3	12 ms	11 ms	14 ms	115.114.89.22 (Regional Telecom Core Backbone)
4	15 ms	14 ms	15 ms	72.21.222.142 (Amazon Border Routing Node)
5	13 ms	13 ms	12 ms	13.235.124.214 (AWS Mumbai Data Center Instance)

```
Trace complete.
```

Figure: Terminal execution and output verification for traceroute path discovery.

Tool 04: DNS Lookup

The 'nslookup' tool was used to run direct queries against designated domain name servers. This tool verifies the target's DNS mapping, resolving web domains to their associated IPv4 and IPv6 target addresses.

```
user@kali:~# nslookup meesho.com

Server:  UnKnown
Address: 192.168.1.1

Non-authoritative answer:
Name:    meesho.com
Addresses: 13.235.124.214
          3.108.106.183
```

Figure: Terminal execution and output verification for nslookup domain resolution.

4. Reconnaissance Analysis & Target Blueprinting

The data collected across these tools was compiled into a structured reconnaissance report, establishing a clear profile of the target domain's public footprint:

Reconnaissance Data Parameter	Extracted Target Attribute Value (meesho.com)
Target Domain Name	meesho.com
Domain Registrar Authority	GoDaddy.com, LLC
Domain Registration Timeline	Created: 2015-03-24 / Updated: 2025-02-18
Resolved IPv4 Network Infrastructure	13.235.124.214 / 3.108.106.183 (AWS India Mumbai Cluster)
Name Server Redundancy Hosts	ns-1158.awsdns-16.org / ns-27.awsdns-03.com
Identified Active Ports Profile	Port 80 (HTTP Server) / Port 443 (HTTPS Secure Gateway)
Boundary Infrastructure Routing Layer	Amazon Web Services (AWS) Cloud Protection Layer

5. Technical Key Takeaways

- **Structured Intelligence:** Reconnaissance maps the layout of target defenses, revealing active components without triggering defensive alerts.
- **Tooling Synergy:** Combining WHOIS data, active ICMP testing, path tracking, and DNS verification forms a reliable verification baseline.
- **Professional Ethics:** Reconnaissance work must respect privacy regulations, protect asset integrity, and operate strictly within authorized testing limits.